

Step 1: Open the project folder

Open **Command Prompt** or **VS Code Terminal**.

Go to your project folder:

```
cd online compliant registration
```

If your project is on the Desktop, for example:

```
cd C:\Users\Mahesh\Desktop\App
```

Step 2: Install and Run the Frontend

Move to the client folder:

```
cd client
```

Install all required packages:

```
npm install
```

Start the React application:

```
npm run dev
```

You should see something like:

```
VITE v5.x.x ready
```

```
Local: http://localhost:5173/
```

Open that URL in your browser.

Step 3: Install Backend Dependencies

Open **another terminal** (don't close the frontend terminal).

Go to the server folder:

```
cd server
```

or if you are already inside `client`:

```
cd ../server
```

Install packages:

```
npm install
```

Step 4: Create the `.env` File

Inside the **server** folder, create a file named:

```
.env
```

Add:

```
PORT=5000
```

```
MONGO_URI=mongodb://localhost:27017/OnlineComplaintRegistration
```

```
JWT_SECRET=mysecretkey
```

```
NODE_ENV=development
```

Your folder should look like:

```
server/
```

```
| — .env
```

```
| — index.js
```

```
| — package.json
```

```
| — routes/
```

```
| — controllers/
```

```
| — models/
```

Step 5: Start MongoDB

Make sure **MongoDB** is running.

Open MongoDB Compass.

Connect to:

```
mongodb://localhost:27017
```

Step 6: Start the Backend

Inside the server folder:

```
node index.js
```

or if you have Nodemon installed:

```
nodemon index.js
```

Expected output:

```
MongoDB Connected  
Server running on port 5000
```

Step 7: Verify Everything

You should have **two terminals** running.

Terminal 1 (Frontend)

```
cd client  
npm run dev
```

Output:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

Terminal 2 (Backend)

```
cd server  
node index.js
```

Output:

```
MongoDB Connected  
Server running on port 5000
```
